

SDG Solutions Challenge 2026 – Official Contestant Handbook & Guidelines

Welcome to the SDG Solutions Challenge, the flagship competition phase of SDG Sprints 2026 organized by the IEEE Sri Lanka Section SIGHT. This initiative empowers young innovators across Sri Lanka to design practical, technology-driven solutions for pressing humanitarian and sustainable development challenges.

1. Eligibility & Team Rules

- Age Requirement: **Open to anyone aged 15 and above (Grade 10 onwards). School students, university undergraduates, and pre-graduates meeting the age requirement are eligible.**
- Membership: **Open to both IEEE and non-IEEE members.**
- Team Size: **1 to 6 members per team.**
- Support & Contact Points:
 - University Students: Your primary contact and mentor throughout the competition is your institution's designated SDG Sprints Ambassador.
 - School Students: Coordination and support are handled directly by the Program & Delivery Team of the Organizing Committee.

2. Innovation Scope & Submission Rules (No Limits)

We encourage you to think big and approach problem-solving without artificial boundaries:

- You are allowed to design a single, comprehensive technology concept that addresses multiple SDGs and solves multiple Problem Statements simultaneously.
- Unlimited Submissions: There is no limit on the number of solutions a team can submit.
- Complete Flexibility: You are free to structure your entries in whichever way best represents your ideas. It can either be:
 - multiple distinct solutions for the same problem statement.
 - multiple distinct solutions for different problem statements (within the same SDG or across different SDGs).

- one unified solution addressing an array of problems and SDGs.
- one solution addressing one problem/SDG.

Simply put, you're totally free to structure your entries in whichever way best represents your ideas and solutions.

3. Competition Roadmap & Evaluation Checkpoints

Note: subject to change - changes will be announced, keep in touch with our social media platforms

Stage / Checkpoint	Duration & Timeline	Deliverables & Requirements	Evaluation Weight
Problem Pool Access	Opens 7 Sept 2026 (12:00 AM)	Explore national problem statements aligned with SDGs.	N/A
Checkpoint 1: Team Registration	Opens 8 Sept 2026 (12:00 AM) - registration closing day will be announced in due course.	Submit team details and selected problem statement(s).	Screening (Pass / Revise)
Checkpoint 2: Problem Validation	8 Oct – 15 Oct 2026	Submit problem research, stakeholder insights, and evidence.	25 Marks
Checkpoint 3: Solution Concept Deck	20 Oct – 03 Nov 2026	Submit a pitch deck detailing technologies used and social impact.	20 Marks
Checkpoint 4: Solution Concept Pitch	05 Nov 2026	Present solution concept to the jury panel (Top 10 shortlisted).	15 Marks
Checkpoint 5: Prototype Development	13 Nov – 10 Dec 2026	Develop a functional prototype; submit video demo & documentation.	25 Marks
Final Showcase & Demo Day	Early January 2027	Physical event: 5-min pitch, 3-min demo, and 5-min jury Q&A.	15 Marks
Total Evaluation			100 Marks

4. Submission & Mentorship Guidelines

- **Problem Selection:** Browse the live Problem Pool, choose one or more statements, and develop your technology-driven SDG solution.
- **Language Flexibility:** While formal submissions and pitch decks should be written clearly in English, community coordination and support are accepted in both English and Sinhala.
- **Mentorship:** Teams advancing to prototype development will be paired with industry and academic mentors to refine technical architecture and implementation feasibility.

5. Core Evaluation Criteria

1. **SDG Alignment & Local Context:** Depth of problem validation and relevance to real community needs in Sri Lanka.
2. **Technological Feasibility & Innovation:** Practicality, technical design, and ethical use of technology.
3. **Humanitarian Impact & Sustainability:** Measurable community benefits and long-term viability.
4. **Execution & Delivery:** Quality of prototype demonstration, documentation clarity, and live presentation effectiveness.

6. Beyond the Hackathon: What Makes this Competition Different?

The **SDG Solutions Challenge** is **NOT just another hackathon that ends at the award ceremony**. Our program is uniquely designed to take your ideas beyond the prototype stage. By participating, you gain unparalleled exposure to both tech and non-tech industry giants. Outstanding solutions will **not only win cash prizes**, but will also **earn the exclusive opportunity to be pitched for real-world implementation**—to secure backing and be brought to life through the Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) funding allocations of our corporate partners.

Stay Connected!

Don't miss out on any of the important announcements or opportunities. Follow our official pages and join the conversation:

- Facebook: [SDG Sprints](#)

- Instagram: [SDG Sprints \(@sdgsprintssl\)](#)
- LinkedIn: [SDG Sprints](#)